



3 Turn the heat down and simmer gently for 1-1½ hours. Test the chutney by dragging a wooden spoon through the mixture along the base of the pan. Make sure you stir the chutney frequently towards the end of the cooking time, so it doesn't catch and burn on the base of the pan.



4 Check the seasoning, add a little more salt if necessary, and pot into warm sterilized jars. Cover the hot chutney with discs of waxed paper and seal the jars. Vinegar corrodes metal, so use plastic lids or metal lids that have a plastic seal or cover.

VARIATION

Runner bean and courgette chutney



Ingredients:

- * 600g (1lb 5oz) runner beans, thinly sliced
- * 4 courgettes, thinly sliced
- * 350g (12oz) cooking apples, peeled, cored, and chopped
- * 2 onions, finely chopped
- * 450g (1lb) light soft brown sugar
- * 1 tsp mustard powder
- * 1 tsp turmeric
- * 1 tsp coriander seeds
- * 600ml (1 pint) cider vinegar

Put all the ingredients in a preserving pan or large, heavy-bottomed saucepan. Cook over a gentle heat, stirring until the sugar has dissolved. Bring to the boil and cook at a rolling boil for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally. Reduce the heat and simmer the mixture for about 1½ hours. Stir continuously towards the end of the cooking time to prevent the mixture from sticking and burning on the base. Test whether the chutney is ready by drawing a spoon across the base of the pan to see if it leaves a clear trail. Ladle into sterilized jars. Place a disc wax-side down over the preserve. Seal with non-metallic or vinegar-proof lids. Label and store in a cool, dark place for at least 1 month for the flavours to mature and mellow. Once opened, keep refrigerated.